advancing in unknown territory does not find the best path at the outset; it is less understandable that a tourist still becomes lost after that territory has been surveyed and mapped down to one part in twenty thousand." Rosenfeld's views were largely shared by the physics community, as one of his friends commented in a letter to him: "I was much amused by the onslaught on David Bohm.… Half a dozen of the most eminent scientists have got their knife into him. Great honor for somebody so young."

Those eminent scientists included not only Rosenfeld and Pauli but also Werner Heisenberg, who dismissed Bohm's theory as "a kind of 'ideological superstructure,' which has little to do with immediate physical reality," and Max Born, who said that Pauli "slays Bohm not only philosophically but physically as well." Yet there were private ideological divisions among Heisenberg, Born, Pauli, Rosenfeld, and the rest of the old guard. Rosenfeld thought Heisenberg was flirting with idealism—a devastating insult from a Marxist—while Pauli and Born thought Rosenfeld was too politically motivated in his science. But the founders of the Copenhagen interpretation closed ranks against Bohm despite their disagreements.

And it wasn't just the old guard who found Bohm's ideas distasteful. Younger physicists, insofar as they paid attention to Bohm at all, were also dismissive of him. In particular, many were troubled by an unavoidable fact of Bohm's theory: it was nonlocal, allowing particles to influence each other instantaneously at long distances. A single particle, wandering the universe on its own without bumping into anything, is guided in its path by its own pilot wave and is perfectly local. But introduce a second particle that interacts in any way with the first, and suddenly they are linked—entangled—and the pilot wave of one particle will change depending on the precise location of the other particle, no matter how distant it may be. This kind of "spooky action at a distance" also appeared in the Copenhagen interpretation—it was exactly what Einstein had argued against in the EPR paper. But many physicists were still unaware of the EPR argument, and most that were aware of it profoundly misunderstood it. To them, the manifest action at a distance in Bohm's theory was another strike against it when compared to Copenhagen.

There was also the question of whether Bohm's ideas would actually lead to new research insights. In particular, because Bohm's theory involved